

Physical Chemistry (I)

Lecture 22

Electrochemistry

Statistical Mechanics



In the Last Class

- Chemical equilibrium
 - Reaction quotient and equilibrium constant
 - Activity
- Le Chatelier's principle
 - Amount change
 - Temperature change (van't Hoff equation)



Last class

Q and K

$$\Delta_r G = \Delta_r G^\ominus + RT \ln Q$$

where the **reaction quotient** Q is defined as

$$Q = \frac{\prod_{\text{product } j} a_j^{v_j}}{\prod_{\text{reactant } i} a_i^{v_i}}$$

At equilibrium, $\Delta_r G = 0$

$$0 = \Delta_r G^\ominus + RT \ln Q_{\text{eq}} = \Delta_r G^\ominus + RT \ln K$$

where the **equilibrium constant** K is Q at equilibrium



Last class

Approximation for Activity

State	Measure	Approximation for a_j	Definition
Solute	molality	$b_j/b^\ominus$	$b^\ominus = 1 \text{ mol kg}^{-1}$
	molar concentration	$[J]/c^\ominus$	$c^\ominus = 1 \text{ mol dm}^{-3}$
Gas phase	partial pressure	$p_j/p^\ominus$	$p^\ominus = 1 \text{ bar}$
Pure solid, liquid		1 (exact)	



(Image: Atkins et al., *Atkins' Physical Chemistry*, 11th ed., p. 208)

Le Chatelier's Principle

When subjected to a disturbance,
a system at equilibrium tends to respond in a way
that **minimizes the effect of the disturbance**.

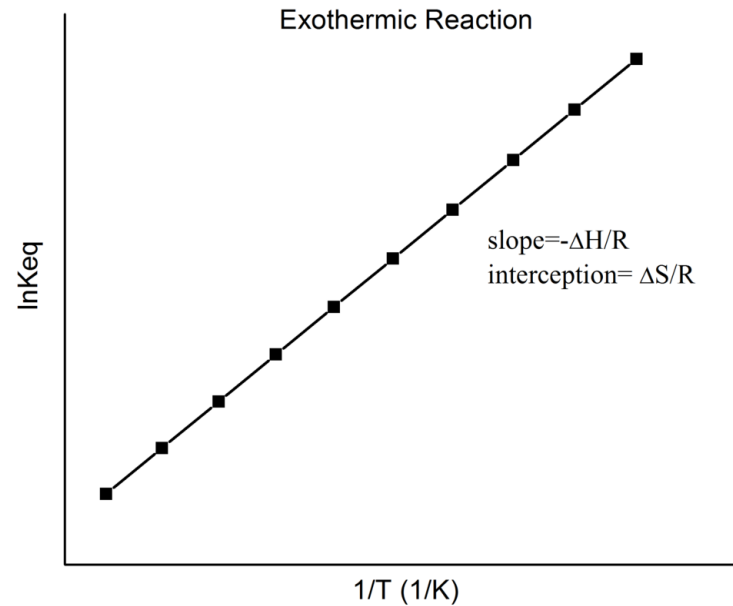
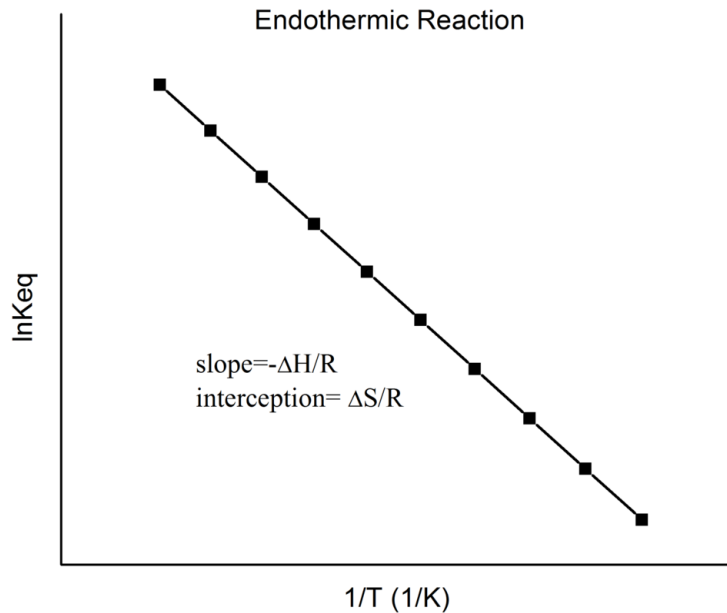
Disturbances to consider:

- Amount (concentration, pressure)
- Temperature

Last class

van't Hoff Equation

$$\frac{d \ln K}{dT} = \frac{\Delta_r H^\ominus}{RT^2}$$



(Image: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Van_%27t_Hoff_equation)

Thermodynamics of Cell

Recall that

$$dG_{T,p} = \delta w_{\text{add,max}} = \delta w_{\text{elec}}$$

for a **reversible** electrochemical reaction.

For an infinitesimal progress of the reaction $d\xi$,

$$dG = \Delta_r G d\xi$$

Hence,

$$\delta w_{\text{elec}} = \Delta_r G d\xi$$

Thermodynamics of Cell

$$\delta w_{\text{elec}} = \Delta_r G d\xi$$

On the other hand, the electrical work is

$$\delta w_{\text{elec}} = \phi dQ$$

where ϕ is the electric field and dQ is the transferred charge. For the electrochemical reaction,

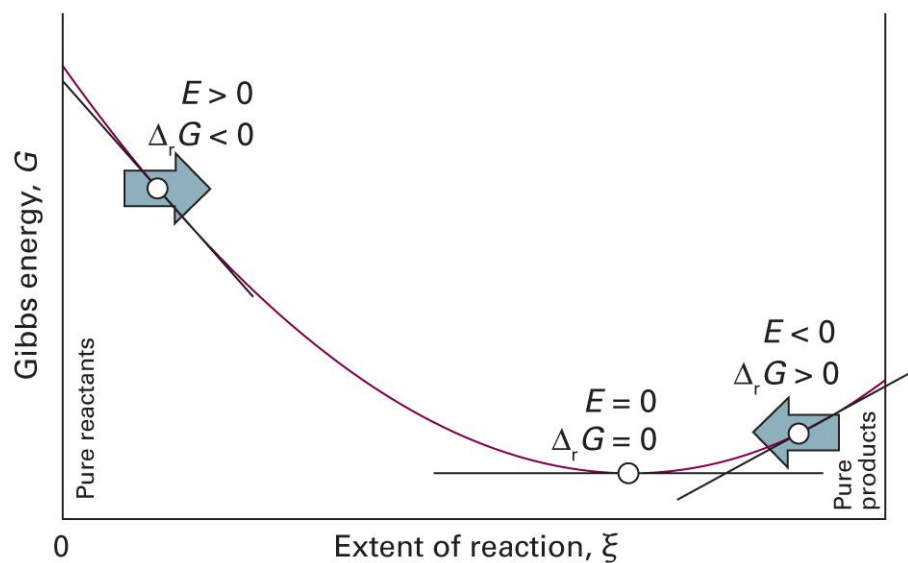
$$\phi = E_{\text{cell}}, \quad dQ = -\nu e N_A d\xi = -\nu F d\xi$$

$$\delta w_{\text{elec}} = -\nu F E_{\text{cell}} d\xi$$

Thus, $\Delta_r G = -\nu F E_{\text{cell}}$

Cell Potential and Reaction

$$\Delta_r G = -\nu F E_{\text{cell}}$$



(Image: Atkins et al., *Atkins' Physical Chemistry*, 11th ed., Figure 6C.4)

Nernst Equation

$$\Delta_r G = -\nu F E_{\text{cell}}$$

Using $\Delta_r G = \Delta_r G^\ominus + RT \ln Q$,

$$-\nu F E_{\text{cell}} = \Delta_r G^\ominus + RT \ln Q$$

Thus,

$$E_{\text{cell}} = E_{\text{cell}}^\ominus - \frac{RT}{\nu F} \ln Q$$

where $E_{\text{cell}}^\ominus = -\Delta_r G^\ominus / \nu F$

At Equilibrium

$$E_{\text{cell}} = E_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus} - \frac{RT}{\nu F} \ln Q$$

At equilibrium, $E_{\text{cell}} = 0$ and $Q = K$

$$0 = E_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus} - \frac{RT}{\nu F} \ln K$$

or,

$$E_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus} = \frac{RT}{\nu F} \ln K$$

Temperature Coefficient

$$E_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus} = -\frac{\Delta_{\text{r}}G^{\ominus}}{\nu F}$$

Since $(\partial G / \partial T)_p = -S$,

$$\frac{dE_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus}}{dT} = -\frac{1}{\nu F} \left(\frac{\partial \Delta_{\text{r}}G^{\ominus}}{\partial T} \right)_p = \frac{\Delta_{\text{r}}S^{\ominus}}{\nu F}$$

Furthermore,

$$\Delta_{\text{r}}H^{\ominus} = \Delta_{\text{r}}G^{\ominus} + T\Delta_{\text{r}}S^{\ominus} = -\nu F \left(E_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus} - T \frac{dE_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus}}{dT} \right)$$

Electrode Potentials

Cell potential = cathode contribution + anode contribution

For a cell L||R,

$$E_{\text{cell}}^{\ominus} = E^{\ominus}(\text{R}) - E^{\ominus}(\text{L})$$

Impossible to measure each contribution

Convention

- Standard hydrogen electrode (SHE): $\text{Pt(s)} | \text{H}_2(\text{g}) | \text{H}^+(\text{aq})$

$E^\ominus = 0$ at all temperatures

- Standard potential $E^\ominus(\text{X})$

For a cell $\text{Pt(s)} | \text{H}_2(\text{g}) | \text{H}^+(\text{aq}) || \text{X}$, $E^\ominus(\text{X}) = E_{\text{cell}}^\ominus$

Standard Potentials

Couple	$E^\ominus/\text{V}$
$\text{Ce}^{4+}(\text{aq}) + \text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Ce}^{3+}(\text{aq})$	+1.61
$\text{Cu}^{2+}(\text{aq}) + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Cu}(\text{s})$	+0.34
$\text{AgCl}(\text{s}) + \text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Ag}(\text{s}) + \text{Cl}^-(\text{aq})$	+0.22
$\text{H}^+(\text{aq}) + \text{e}^- \rightarrow \frac{1}{2}\text{H}_2(\text{g})$	0
$\text{Zn}^{2+}(\text{aq}) + 2\text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Zn}(\text{s})$	-0.76
$\text{Na}^+(\text{aq}) + \text{e}^- \rightarrow \text{Na}(\text{s})$	-2.71

Thermodynamics of Potentials

Each electrode potential can be converted into

$$-vFE^{\ominus} = \Delta_r G^{\ominus}$$

When a combination of reactions a and b gives reaction c,

$$\Delta_r G^{\ominus}(c) = \Delta_r G^{\ominus}(a) + \Delta_r G^{\ominus}(b)$$

$$-v_c F E^{\ominus}(c) = -v_a F E^{\ominus}(a) - v_b F E^{\ominus}(b)$$

Thus,

$$v_c E^{\ominus}(c) = v_a E^{\ominus}(a) + v_b E^{\ominus}(b)$$

Reducing Power

For two redox couples $\text{Ox}_\text{L}/\text{Red}_\text{L}$ and $\text{Ox}_\text{R}/\text{Red}_\text{R}$,
the cell reaction $\text{Red}_\text{L} + \text{Ox}_\text{R} \rightarrow \text{Ox}_\text{L} + \text{Red}_\text{R}$ has

- $K > 1$: $E^\ominus_{\text{cell}} > 0$ and $E^\ominus(\text{L}) < E^\ominus(\text{R})$
- $K < 1$: $E^\ominus_{\text{cell}} < 0$ and $E^\ominus(\text{L}) > E^\ominus(\text{R})$

Red_L has a thermodynamic tendency to reduce Ox_R
if $E^\ominus(\text{L}) < E^\ominus(\text{R})$

Electrochemical Series

Least strongly reducing

Gold (Au^{3+}/Au)

Platinum (Pt^{2+}/Pt)

Silver (Ag^+/Ag)

Mercury (Hg^{2+}/Hg)

Copper (Cu^{2+}/Cu)

Hydrogen (H^+/H_2)

Tin (Sn^{2+}/Sn)

Nickel (Ni^{2+}/Ni)

Iron (Fe^{2+}/Fe)

Zinc (Zn^{2+}/Zn)

Chromium (Cr^{3+}/Cr)

Aluminium (Al^{3+}/Al)

Magnesium (Mg^{2+}/Mg)

Sodium (Na^+/Na)

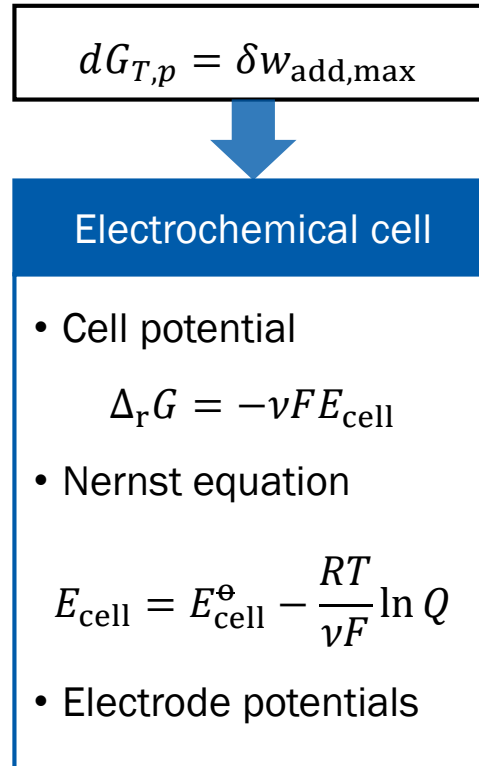
Calcium (Ca^{2+}/Ca)

Potassium (K^+/K)

Most strongly reducing



Summary



10. Statistical Mechanics



Chapter Overview

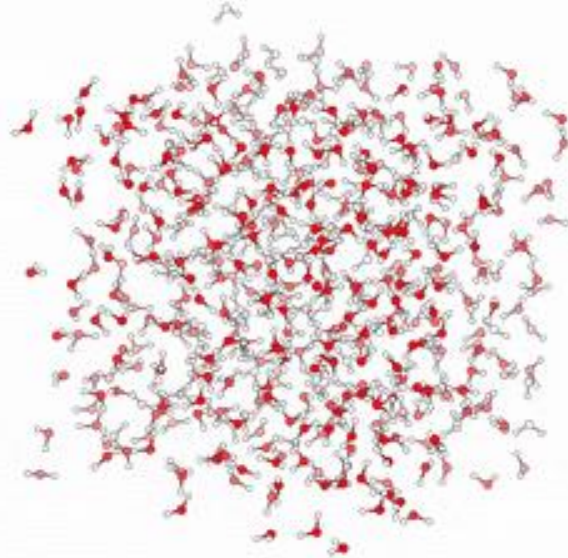
- Maxwell-Boltzmann statistics
 - Boltzmann factor and partition function
 - Classical statistical mechanics: phase space
- Partition function and thermodynamics
 - Generalization of partition function
 - Partition function and thermodynamic quantities
- Applications
 - Perfect gas and real gas
 - Equipartition theorem



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Statistical Mechanics

Thermodynamics (p , V , T , ...)



“Statistics” of
individual particles

(Image: https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:MD_water.gif)

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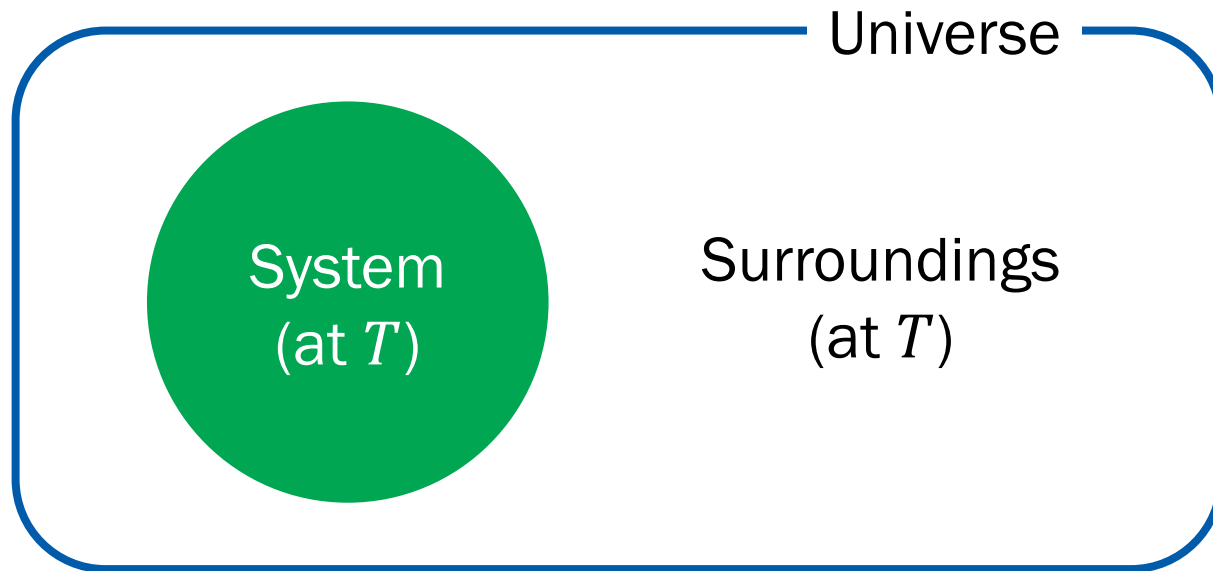
Maxwell-Boltzmann Statistics

Average distribution of independent particles
of a system in **thermal equilibrium**

Described by the **Boltzmann factor**

System Microstates

For a closed system with constant V and n ,



Consider two microstates s_1 and s_2 .

Probabilities

- Probability of having s_i is proportional to the number of microstates in the surroundings

$$P(s_i) \propto W_{\text{surr}}(s_i)$$

- Ratio between probabilities of having s_1 and s_2

$$\frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)} = \frac{W_{\text{surr}}(s_2)}{W_{\text{surr}}(s_1)}$$

Entropy Comes in

$$\frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)} = \frac{W_{\text{surr}}(s_2)}{W_{\text{surr}}(s_1)}$$

Using the statistical definition of entropy, $S = k_B \ln W$,

$$\frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)} = \frac{e^{S_{\text{surr}}(s_2)/k_B}}{e^{S_{\text{surr}}(s_1)/k_B}} = e^{\{S_{\text{surr}}(s_2) - S_{\text{surr}}(s_1)\}/k_B}$$

What is $S_{\text{surr}}(s_2) - S_{\text{surr}}(s_1)$?

Entropy of Surroundings

Recall the fundamental equation of thermodynamics:

$$dU = TdS - pdV + \mu dn = TdS \text{ (at constant } V \text{ and } n)$$

For constant T , $\Delta U = T\Delta S$ and

$$\begin{aligned} S_{\text{surr}}(s_2) - S_{\text{surr}}(s_1) &= \frac{1}{T} \{U_{\text{surr}}(s_2) - U_{\text{surr}}(s_1)\} \\ &= -\frac{1}{T} \{U(s_2) - U(s_1)\} \end{aligned}$$

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Written in System Variables

$$\frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)} = e^{\{S_{\text{surr}}(s_2) - S_{\text{surr}}(s_1)\}/k_B}$$

$$S_{\text{surr}}(s_2) - S_{\text{surr}}(s_1) = -\frac{1}{T}\{U(s_2) - U(s_1)\}$$

Combining the two equations,

$$\frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)} = e^{-\{U(s_2) - U(s_1)\}/k_B T} = \frac{e^{-U(s_2)/k_B T}}{e^{-U(s_1)/k_B T}}$$

Boltzmann Factor

$$\frac{P(s_2)}{P(s_1)} = \frac{e^{-U(s_2)/k_B T}}{e^{-U(s_1)/k_B T}}$$

In general, for a microstate s with energy E ,

$$P(s) \propto e^{-E(s)/k_B T} \text{ (Boltzmann factor)}$$

or, using a constant q ,

$$P(s) = \frac{1}{q} e^{-E(s)/k_B T}$$

Determination of q

$$P(s) = \frac{1}{q} e^{-E(s)/k_B T}$$

Using the normalization condition, $\sum_s P(s) = 1$,

$$1 = \sum_s \frac{1}{q} e^{-E(s)/k_B T} = \frac{1}{q} \sum_s e^{-E(s)/k_B T}$$

$$q = \sum_s e^{-E(s)/k_B T}$$

(Partition function)

Brief Illustration 12A.2

Suppose that two conformations of a molecule differ in energy by 5.0 kJ mol⁻¹ (corresponding to 8.3×10^{-21} J for a single molecule), so conformation A lies at energy 0 and conformation B lies at $\varepsilon = 8.3 \times 10^{-21}$ J. What is the proportion of molecules in conformation B at 293 K?

$$E(A)/k_B T = 0 / \{(1.381 \times 10^{-23} \text{ J K}^{-1}) \times (293 \text{ K})\} = 0$$

$$E(B)/k_B T = (8.3 \times 10^{-21} \text{ J}) / \{(1.381 \times 10^{-23} \text{ J K}^{-1}) \times (293 \text{ K})\} = 2.05$$

The partition function is

$$q = \sum_s e^{-E(s)/k_B T} = e^{-E(A)/k_B T} + e^{-E(B)/k_B T} = e^0 + e^{-2.05} = 1.13$$

Brief Illustration 12A.2

$$q = 1.13$$

Hence, the proportion of molecules in conformation B is

$$P(\text{B}) = \frac{1}{q} e^{-E(\text{B})/k_{\text{B}}T} = \frac{1}{1.13} e^{-2.05} = 0.11$$

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Classical Statistical Mechanics

What is a **microstate** of a classical particle?

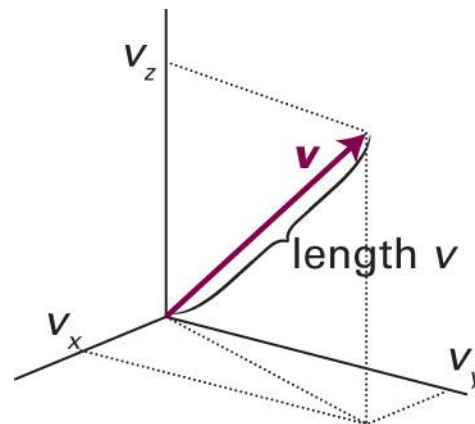


Position and Velocity

Each particle with mass m has its own

- Position $\vec{r} = (x, y, z)$
- Velocity $\vec{v} = (v_x, v_y, v_z)$

$$\vec{v} = \frac{d\vec{r}}{dt} = \left(\frac{dx}{dt}, \frac{dy}{dt}, \frac{dz}{dt} \right)$$



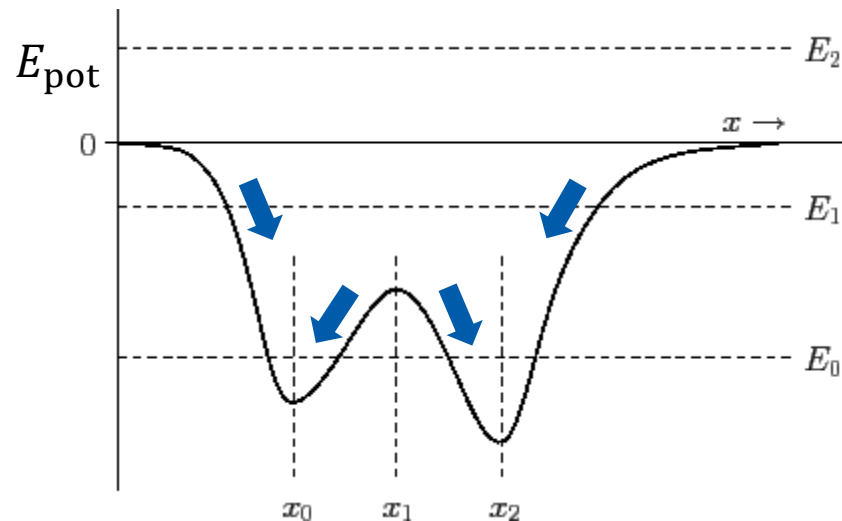
With the velocity, we can define:

- Speed $v = |\vec{v}| = (v_x^2 + v_y^2 + v_z^2)^{1/2}$
- Kinetic energy $E_k = mv^2/2 = m(v_x^2 + v_y^2 + v_z^2)/2$

Newton's Second Law

$$\vec{F} = m\vec{a}$$

- Force $\vec{F}$: negative slope of potential energy ($-\nabla E_{\text{pot}}$)



(Image: <http://farside.ph.utexas.edu/teaching/336k/Newtonhtml/node16.html>)

Newton's Second Law

$$\vec{F} = m\vec{a}$$

- Acceleration $\vec{a}$: second time-derivative of position

$$\vec{a} = \frac{d\vec{v}}{dt} = \frac{d^2\vec{r}}{dt^2}$$

$$-\nabla E_{\text{pot}} = m \frac{d^2\vec{r}}{dt^2}$$

↑
given

Second-Order ODE

$$\frac{d^2 \vec{r}}{dt^2} = - \frac{\nabla E_{\text{pot}}}{m}$$

Two conditions are required to obtain the full dynamics:

(initial) position and (initial) velocity (= momentum)

Phase Space

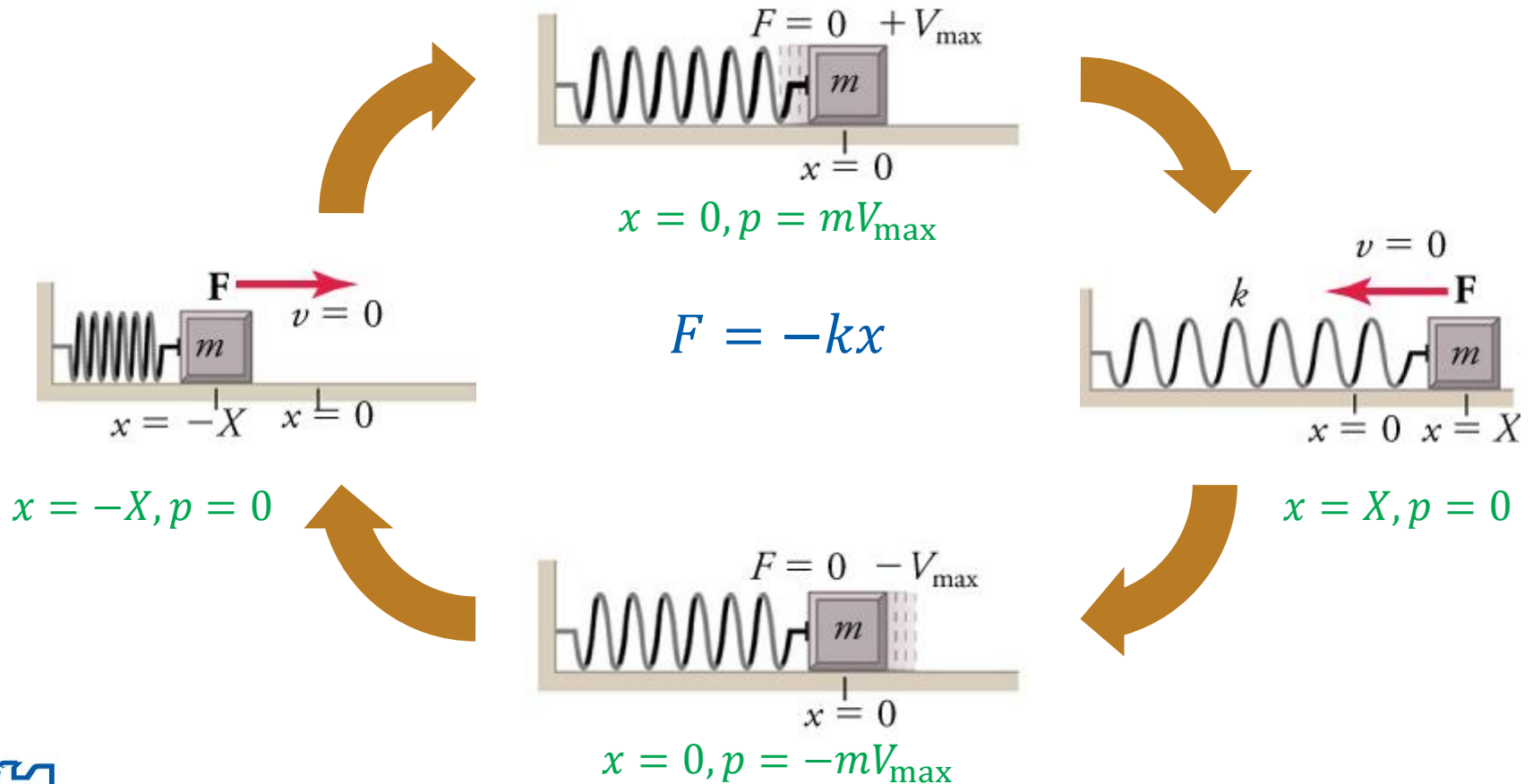
Space of **all possible microstates** of a system

- Classical mechanics:

Space of all possible values of
position and **momentum** variables

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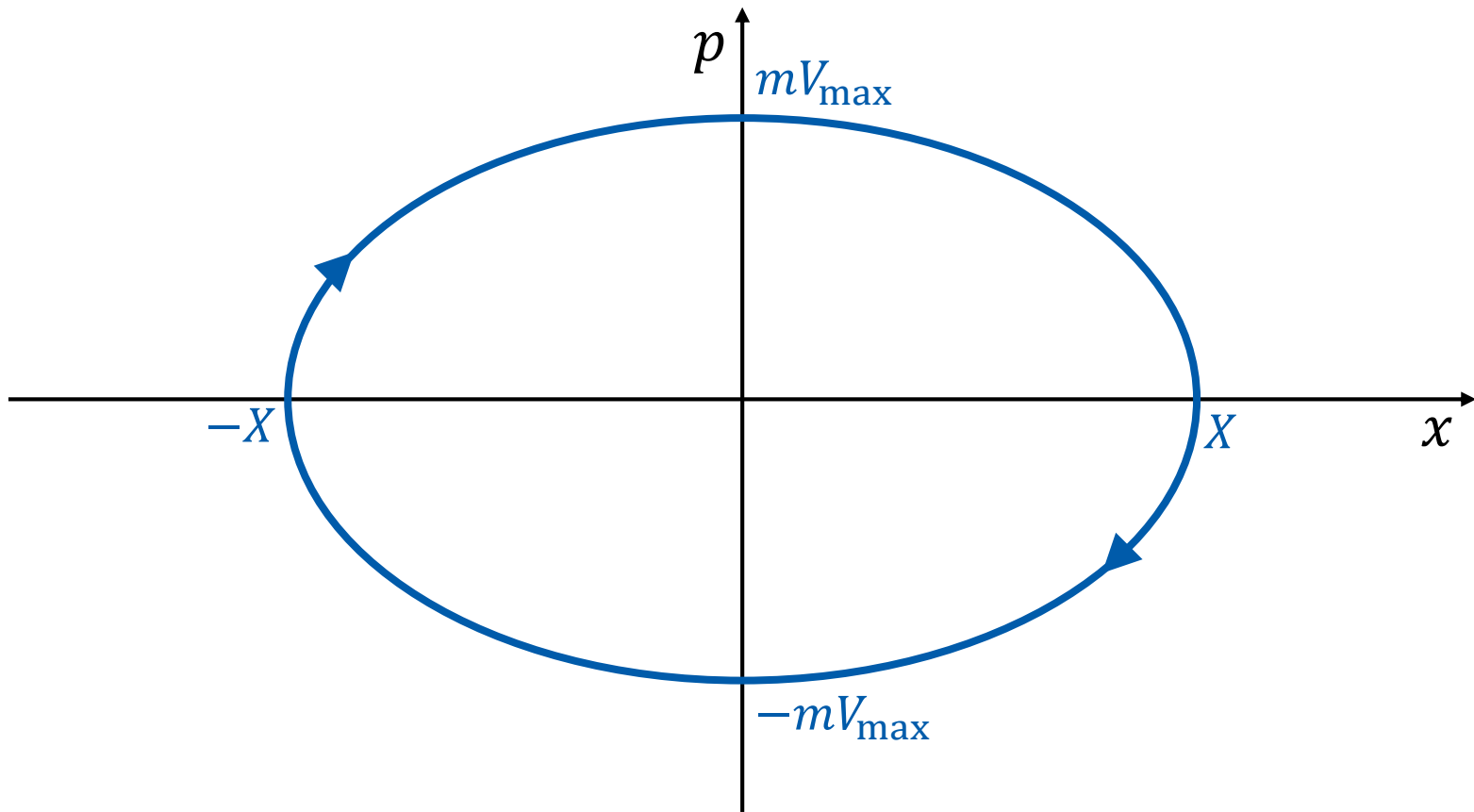
1-Dimensional Spring



(Image: <https://openstax.org/books/physics/pages/5-5-simple-harmonic-motion>)

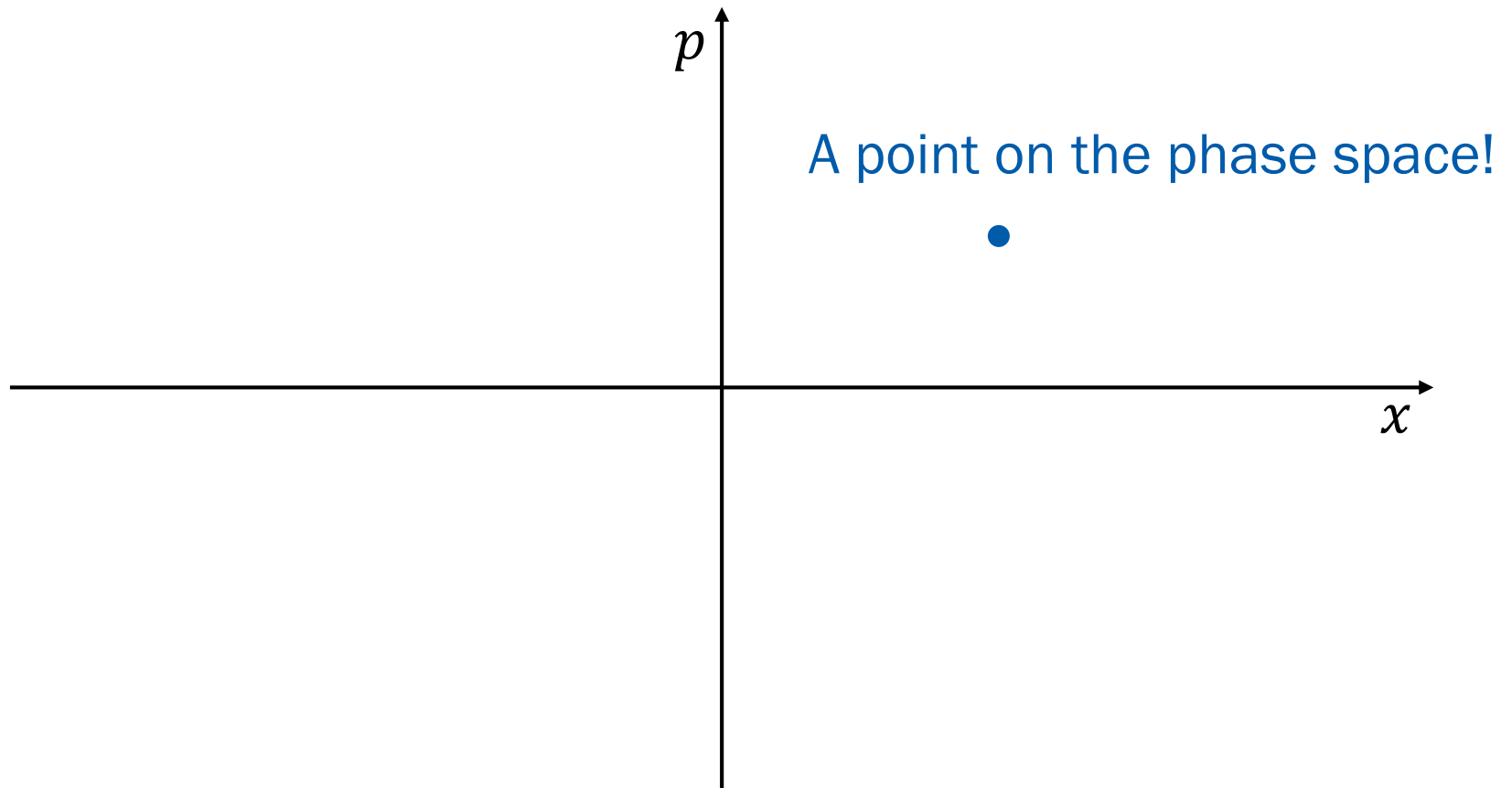
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Phase Space Representation



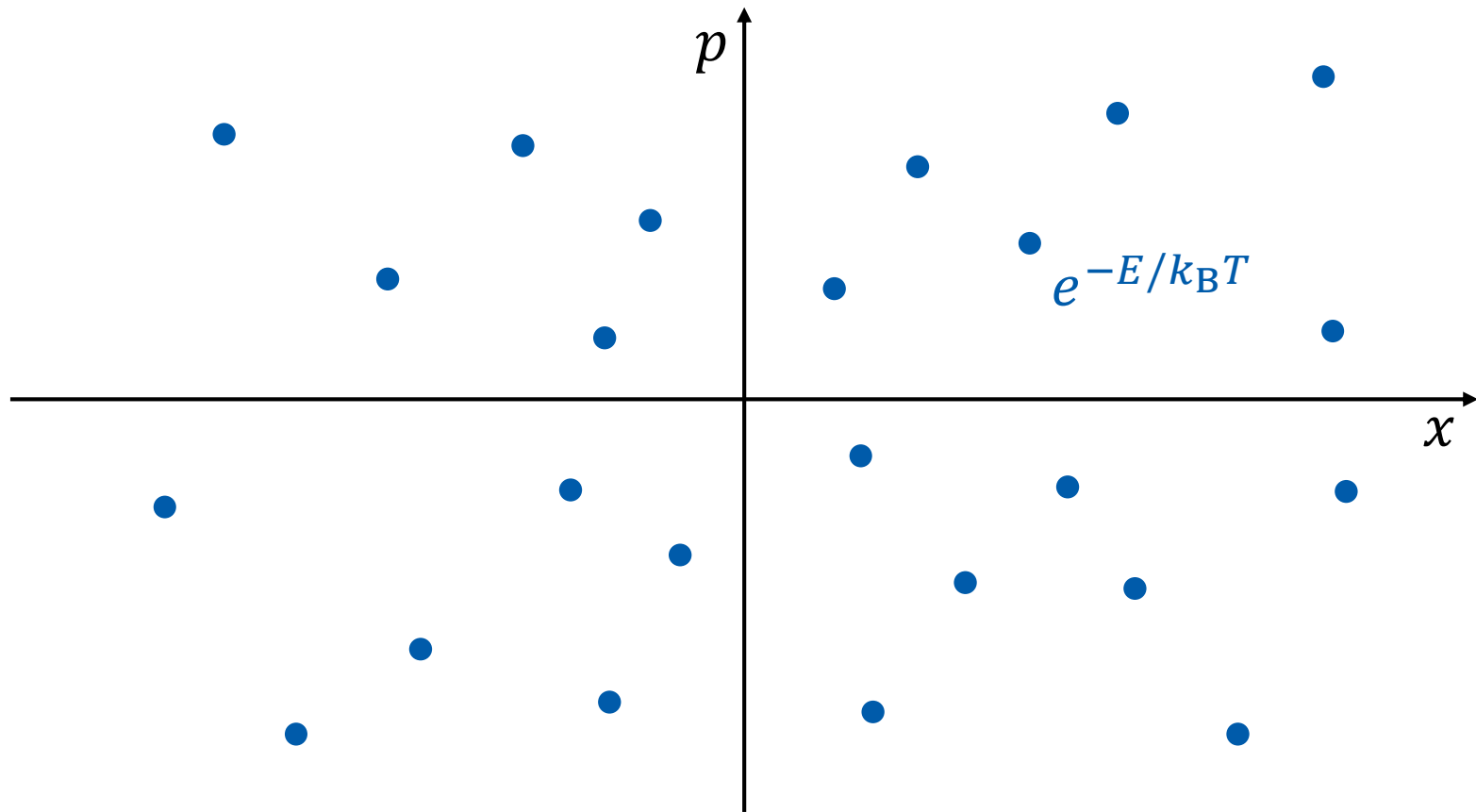
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Microstate of Classical Particle



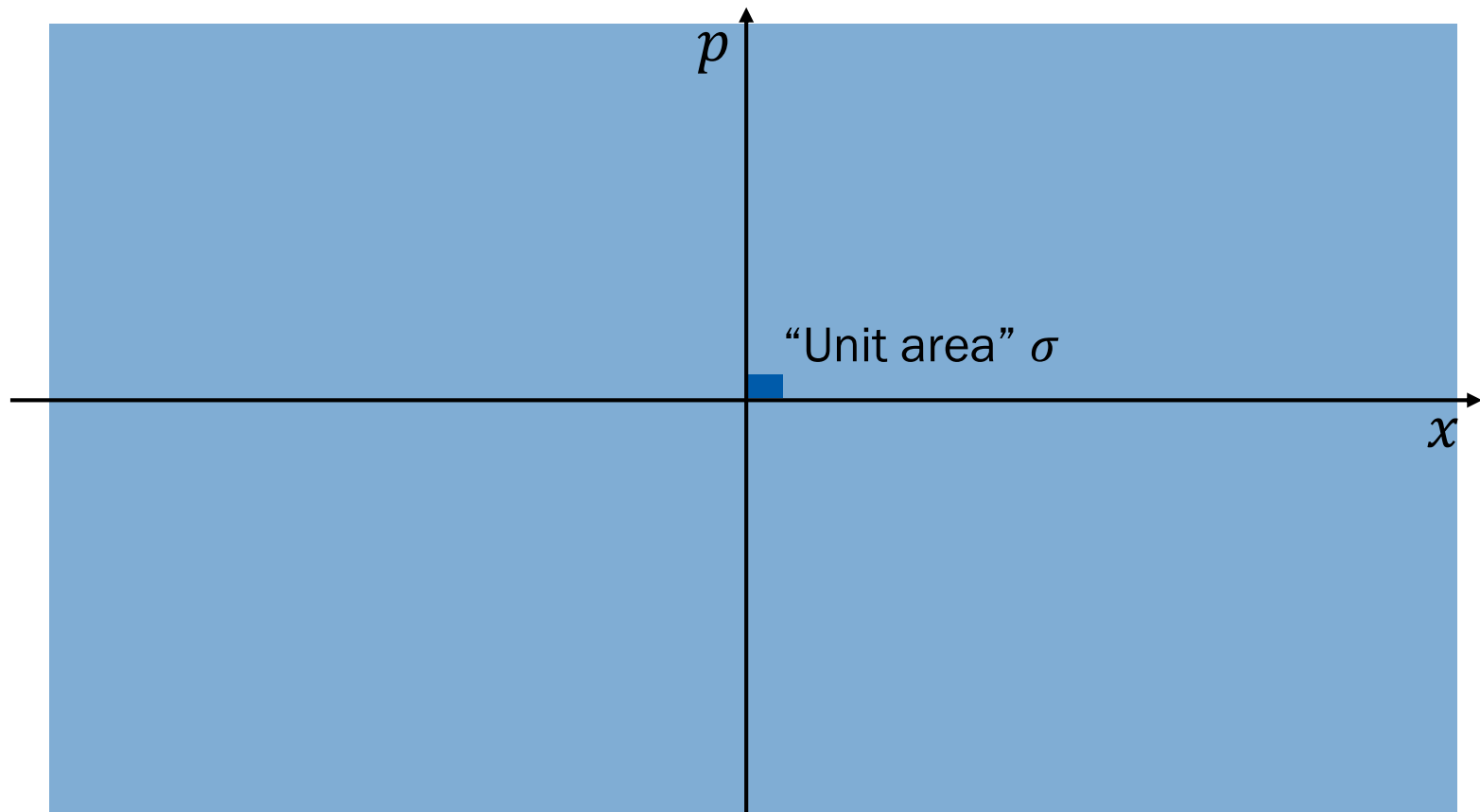
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Partition Function



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Partition Function



Partition Function

$$q = \sum_s e^{-E(s)/k_B T} \rightarrow q = \frac{1}{\sigma} \int \int e^{-E(x,p)/k_B T} dx dp$$

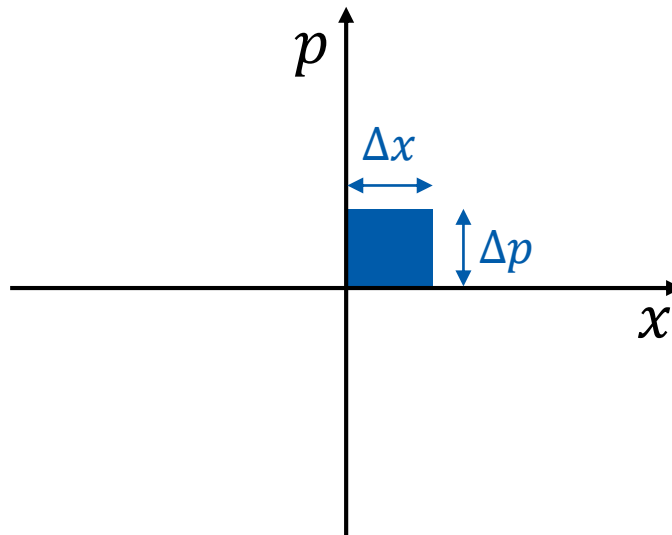
for a 1-dimensional single particle

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What is σ ?

From Heisenberg's uncertainty principle,

$$\Delta x \Delta p \geq h \text{ (Planck's constant)}$$



Take $\sigma = h!$

Partition Function

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \int \int e^{-E(x,p)/k_B T} dx dp$$

- Example: 1-dimensional spring

$$E(x, p) = \frac{1}{2} k x^2 + \frac{1}{2} m v^2 = \frac{1}{2} k x^2 + \frac{p^2}{2m}$$

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{1}{k_B T} \left(\frac{1}{2} k x^2 + \frac{p^2}{2m} \right)} dx dp$$

1-Dimensional Spring

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{1}{k_B T} \left(\frac{1}{2} k x^2 + \frac{p^2}{2m} \right)} dx dp$$

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{kx^2}{2k_B T} - \frac{p^2}{2mk_B T}} dx dp$$

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{kx^2}{2k_B T}} \times e^{-\frac{p^2}{2mk_B T}} dx dp$$

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{kx^2}{2k_B T}} dx \right] \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2mk_B T}} dp \right]$$

Gaussian Integrals

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{kx^2}{2k_B T}} dx \right] \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\frac{p^2}{2mk_B T}} dp \right]$$

Using $\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} e^{-\alpha x^2} dx = \sqrt{\pi/\alpha},$

$$q = \frac{1}{h} \sqrt{\frac{2\pi k_B T}{k}} \sqrt{2m\pi k_B T} = \frac{2\pi k_B T}{h} \sqrt{\frac{m}{k}}$$